

FAMILY STUDIES

OVERVIEW

In the social sciences and humanities curriculum, family studies is a multidisciplinary subject area that encompasses four areas: fashion and housing; food and nutrition; general family studies; and raising and caring for children. The topics covered in these areas include, among others: textile production; the functions and design of clothing; the fashion industry; issues related to housing; interior design; the role of nutrition in health; the relationship between food and culture; human and family interactions and development; life management skills; various types of relationships; and considerations related to raising and caring for children.

In family studies courses, students learn about laws and policies that affect individuals and families in Canada and around the world. They also become familiar with the theoretical perspectives and practical research that underpin our understandings of individual and family development. Family studies courses also integrate theory and practical skills. Many expectations can be achieved through practical experiences both in the classroom and in co-op placements, some of which may be affiliated with Specialist High Skills Majors programs.

All courses in family studies encourage students to develop critical and creative thinking skills. Students are given opportunities to deepen their understanding of relevant issues and to develop practical skills, including research and inquiry skills. Students are encouraged to explore a range of perspectives and approaches and to develop the habits of mind that enhance individual, family, and community well-being and contribute to lifelong learning.

FOOD AND NUTRITION

Food and Healthy Living, Grade 12

Workplace Preparation

HFL4E

This course focuses on the fundamental food needs of young adults. Students will learn how to stock a kitchen, make nutritious food choices, and accommodate the food needs of others. Through a range of practical experiences, they will develop skills needed in food preparation for personal use and for employment in the food industry. They will also learn about dining etiquette in different contexts and about responsible consumer practices. Students will use social science research methods to investigate issues related to food preparation and nutrition.

Prerequisite: None

A. RESEARCH AND INQUIRY SKILLS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1. Exploring:** explore topics related to personal food preparation and consumption, and formulate questions to guide their research;
- A2. Investigating:** create research plans, and locate and select information relevant to their chosen topics, using appropriate social science research and inquiry methods;
- A3. Processing Information:** assess, record, analyse, and synthesize information gathered through research and inquiry;
- A4. Communicating and Reflecting:** communicate the results of their research and inquiry clearly and effectively, and reflect on and evaluate their research, inquiry, and communication skills.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Exploring

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1.1** explore a variety of topics related to personal food preparation and consumption (*e.g., food safety, trends in food and nutrition, meal-planning strategies*) to identify topics for research and inquiry
- A1.2** identify key concepts (*e.g., through discussion, brainstorming, use of visual organizers*) related to their chosen topic
- A1.3** formulate effective questions to guide their research and inquiry
Teacher prompt: “If you were researching sources of omega-3 fatty acids, why might you want to compare vegetarian to non-vegetarian sources? Which aspects would be important to compare (*e.g., cost, taste, ethical or environmental considerations, or nutrient levels*)?”

A2. Investigating

Throughout this course, students will:

- A2.1** create appropriate research plans to investigate their selected topics (*e.g., outline purpose and method; identify sources of information*), ensuring that their plans follow guidelines for ethical research
Teacher prompts: “What are some ways to locate reliable sources of information?” “For which purposes might websites such as

Wikipedia be adequate sources of information? What are the risks of relying on websites such as Wikipedia?”

- A2.2** locate and select information relevant to their investigations from a variety of primary sources (*e.g., informal interviews, surveys, observations, food logs, grocery bills*) and/or secondary sources (*e.g., textbooks, advertisements, brochures, newspaper articles, websites, cookbooks*)
Teacher prompts: “What is the difference between primary and secondary sources? How can you determine whether a source is a primary or secondary source?” “What criteria would you use to choose the best secondary source for information about your research question?”
- A2.3** based on preliminary research, for each investigation formulate a hypothesis, thesis statement, or research question, and use it to focus their research

A3. Processing Information

Throughout this course, students will:

- A3.1** assess various aspects of information gathered from primary and secondary sources (*e.g., accuracy, relevance, reliability, bias*)
Teacher prompts: “What strategies can you use to determine the relevance of the information you have gathered?” “If two information sources contradict each other, how might you determine which is more reliable?”

A3.2 record and organize information and key ideas using a variety of formats (*e.g., notes, graphic organizers, audio/visual/digital records*)

A3.3 analyse and interpret research information (*e.g., determine whether common themes arise in different sources*)

A3.4 demonstrate academic honesty by documenting the sources of all information generated through research

A3.5 synthesize findings and formulate conclusions (*e.g., weigh and connect information to determine the answer to their research question*)

A4. Communicating and Reflecting

Throughout this course, students will:

A4.1 use an appropriate format (*e.g., brochure, flyer, poster, report, multimedia presentation*) to communicate the results of their research and inquiry effectively for a specific purpose and audience

A4.2 use terms relating to personal food preparation and consumption correctly (*e.g., food budgeting, menu planning, comparison shopping, healthy choices*)

A4.3 clearly communicate the results of their inquiries (*e.g., write clearly, organize ideas logically, use language conventions properly*), and follow APA conventions for acknowledging sources (*e.g., generate a reference list in APA style*)

A4.4 demonstrate an understanding of the general research process by reflecting on and evaluating their own research, inquiry, and communication skills

Teacher prompt: “What steps might you take to enhance your research/inquiry skills?”

B. KITCHEN FUNDAMENTALS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. Kitchen Safety:** demonstrate an understanding of practices that ensure or enhance kitchen safety;
- B2. Food Safety:** demonstrate an understanding of practices that ensure or enhance food safety;
- B3. Food Preparation:** demonstrate skills needed in food preparation;
- B4. Kitchen Essentials:** demonstrate an understanding of how to stock and organize a starter kitchen.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. Kitchen Safety

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** describe common accidents that can occur in the kitchen (*e.g., cuts, burns, fires, falls, poisoning, electric shocks*)
- B1.2** demonstrate an understanding of safe practices within the food-preparation area (*e.g., safely handle hot foods; prevent spatters, scalds, and cuts; wipe up spills immediately*)
- B1.3** demonstrate an understanding of appropriate emergency responses to common accidents associated with food preparation (*e.g., cuts, burns, scalds, fires*)

B2. Food Safety

By the end of this course, students will:

- B2.1** outline the causes and symptoms of food-borne illnesses (*e.g., E. coli poisoning, botulism poisoning, Clostridium perfringens poisoning, salmonellosis, listeriosis*) and techniques for preventing these illnesses
- B2.2** use appropriate personal hygiene practices to prevent contamination of food (*e.g., wash hands frequently; cover a cough or sneeze in their sleeve; use gloves to cover cuts or wounds; tie hair back*)
- B2.3** use safe food-handling practices to prevent cross-contamination by pathogens, parasites, and allergens in the food-preparation area (*e.g., wash fresh produce; sanitize cutting boards after contact with meat products; sanitize implements*

that come into contact with allergens when preparing food for or with people with known allergies; sanitize work surfaces; replace or sanitize sponges or cloths frequently; use proper clean-up procedures)

- B2.4** follow appropriate protocols to ensure food safety (*e.g., cook foods to recommended temperatures; keep hot foods hot and cold foods cold; store food appropriately; wipe tops of cans before opening; check "best-before" dates; demonstrate awareness of common allergenic ingredients*)

B3. Food Preparation

By the end of this course, students will:

- B3.1** identify and select appropriate tools, equipment, and ingredients for use in food preparation
- B3.2** demonstrate the ability to safely use, maintain, clean, and store tools and equipment used in food preparation
- B3.3** demonstrate the ability to adapt recipes by substituting equipment and ingredients that are readily available (*e.g., use a frying pan instead of a wok; use milk with vinegar instead of buttermilk; use dried instead of fresh herbs*)
- B3.4** demonstrate the ability to measure quantities accurately (*e.g., use different strategies for measuring wet and dry ingredients; level off excess amounts; measure liquids at eye level*)
- B3.5** demonstrate the correct use of food-preparation techniques (*e.g., stirring, beating, whipping, chopping, broiling, frying*)

B3.6 select an appropriate cooking method for various foods (e.g., choose among boiling, steaming, or roasting vegetables; use a microwave oven to cook frozen foods or reheat leftovers; choose among stewing, grilling, or roasting to cook meat)

Teacher prompt: “In what different ways can a microwave oven be used to prepare food? For cooking which types of food are microwave ovens inappropriate?”

B3.7 demonstrate the ability to manage preparation and cooking times so that all components of a course are ready simultaneously

Teacher prompt: “What strategies can you use to ensure that a salad, pasta, and sauce would be ready at the same time?”

B3.8 plan, prepare, and serve a food item or items for a specific occasion or purpose (e.g., for a special occasion, to meet special dietary needs)

B4. Kitchen Essentials

By the end of this course, students will:

B4.1 assess personal food preferences to identify the equipment and food products needed to stock a starter kitchen

Teacher prompts: “How might personal preferences influence the food and equipment used in a kitchen?” “How might a person’s starter kitchen vary in utensils and food products according to the person’s age and ethnocultural background?”

B4.2 identify various utensils and appliances needed in a starter kitchen and their uses (e.g., microwave oven, slow cooker, toaster oven, blender, electric frying pan, measuring spoons and cups, spatula, can opener, cutting board, paring knife, tongs)

B4.3 identify the basic staple food items needed in a starter kitchen (e.g., flour, sugar, canned goods, spices, rice, legumes)

B4.4 identify criteria to use when comparison shopping for kitchen equipment (e.g., price, quality, warranty, range of functions, energy efficiency, size)

Teacher prompt: “What features would you look for when purchasing a microwave oven, a set of knives, or a can opener?”

B4.5 describe the optimal placement of kitchen items for maximum efficiency and safety (e.g., in the work triangle, fridge, stove, and sink should be within easy reach of one another; pots and pans should be near the stove; cleaning supplies should be separate from food items)

C. FOOD FUNDAMENTALS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Healthy Eating:** demonstrate an understanding of the components of healthy eating;
- C2. Diverse Food Needs:** demonstrate an understanding of the importance of meeting diverse food needs;
- C3. Menu Planning:** demonstrate an understanding of factors to consider in menu planning.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Healthy Eating

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** identify key recommendations in Canada's Food Guide (*e.g., foods emphasized, recommended nutrient intakes for specific groups, recommended activity levels*)
- C1.2** describe appropriate serving sizes as indicated in Canada's Food Guide
Teacher prompts: "How do your own typical serving sizes compare to those of Canada's Food Guide?" "How can the ability to estimate serving sizes help you follow the recommendations in Canada's Food Guide?"
- C1.3** identify the main nutrients found in the basic food groups (*e.g., energy-yielding nutrients, calcium, vitamin D, folic acid, iron*) and their importance for optimal physical health
- C1.4** explain why it is important to achieve balance, moderation, and variety in their diet, and describe strategies for doing so (*e.g., choosing foods from each of the food groups; including different-coloured fruits and vegetables; choosing complex rather than simple carbohydrates; eating moderate-sized portions*)
Teacher prompt: "How does including fruits and vegetables of different colours in your diet contribute to healthy eating?"
- C1.5** compare fresh, frozen, and canned foods using a variety of criteria (*e.g., price, taste, nutritional value, convenience*)

- C1.6** compare home-made foods to ready-made and packaged foods using a variety of criteria (*e.g., quality, nutrient density, fat and sodium content, additives*)

Teacher prompt: "What criteria are most important to you when comparing food products? Why?"

- C1.7** analyse current issues and trends in food and nutrition to determine their influence on people's health (*e.g., trans-fat regulations; popularity of energy drinks, "enriched" water, protein shakes; debates about the use of bisphenol A in food packaging; popularity of fad diets*)

- C1.8** outline a personal meal plan that emphasizes nutrition, balance, and variety

C2. Diverse Food Needs

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** identify factors that influence people's dietary needs and preferences (*e.g., allergies, food likes and dislikes, medical conditions requiring special diets, religious affiliations, cultural traditions*)
- C2.2** describe strategies to accommodate diverse dietary needs and preferences (*e.g., substituting foods, using new or specialty food products, offering choices, asking guests about needs or preferences*)
Teacher prompt: "How might you plan or modify a dinner menu to meet the needs of a vegan diet?"

C3. Menu Planning

By the end of this course, students will:

- C3.1** identify key considerations in meal planning (*e.g., time, budget, skills, schedules, recommendations in Canada's Food Guide, diverse needs and preferences of others*)
- C3.2** describe ways to maintain a varied diet while using ingredients purchased in large quantities (*e.g., rice, potatoes, oatmeal*)
- C3.3** describe ways of using leftovers effectively (*e.g., in casseroles, soups, salads, stir-fries, sandwiches*)

Teacher prompt: "What are some ways of using leftover roast chicken?"

- C3.4** outline strategies for eliminating waste in menu planning and meal preparation (*e.g., freezing individual-size portions; using most or all parts of vegetables or cuts of meat*)

Teacher prompt: "What can be done with broccoli stalks, celery tops, potato water, or meat bones?"

- C3.5** demonstrate an ability to plan a menu for several days using a variety of meal-planning strategies

D. THE FOOD CONSUMER

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Food Shopping:** demonstrate an understanding of efficient and economical purchasing strategies that ensure food safety and quality;
- D2. Responsible Consumerism:** demonstrate an understanding of practices related to responsible consumerism;
- D3. Consumer Literacy and Numeracy:** demonstrate the literacy and numeracy skills needed to get good value for their food dollar;
- D4. Eating Out:** demonstrate an understanding of etiquette and logistics related to eating out.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Food Shopping

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1.1** identify various places where food can be obtained (*e.g., grocery store, farmers' market, culture-specific food market, bulk food store, restaurants, school cafeteria, take-out, delicatessen, the wild [for game, fish, wild fruits, and edible plants], community garden, community kitchen, food bank*)

- D1.2** identify strategies that contribute to efficiency and economy in food purchasing (*e.g., determining needs, making a list, planning menus, making and sticking to a budget, not shopping when hungry, avoiding impulse buying*)

Teacher prompt: "How can people purchase food economically and efficiently even if they do not own a car?"

- D1.3** describe strategies they can use to reduce food costs (*e.g., reading flyers, clipping coupons, purchasing generic brands, buying in bulk*)

Teacher prompts: "When might it be economical to use prepared foods rather than home-cooked foods?" "In which situations could flyers and coupons contribute to increased food costs?"

- D1.4** describe shopping practices they can use to ensure food quality and safety (*e.g., assessing ripeness, avoiding dented cans, checking "best-before" dates, buying fresh vegetables and fruits in season*)

- D1.5** identify proper methods for storing perishable and non perishable foods (*e.g., refrigeration, freezing, drying, canning*)

D2. Responsible Consumerism

By the end of this course, students will:

- D2.1** describe environmentally responsible ways of acquiring food (*e.g., buying locally, bartering or exchanging, growing their own vegetables*)

Teacher prompt: "How does buying locally grown produce help the environment?"

- D2.2** describe some environmentally responsible food-preparation practices (*e.g., using energy-efficient appliances; filling the freezer to the recommended level; using fewer pots in cooking; using a microwave oven rather than a conventional oven to cook a small amount of food; using as many parts of an item of food as possible; planning meals to avoid overshopping, eating out, or food waste*)

- D2.3** describe strategies they can use at home to reduce food waste and excess packaging (*e.g., separating out recyclable materials, vermicomposting, using reusable fabric shopping bags, buying in bulk, refusing excess packaging*)

Teacher prompt: "What are some environmentally responsible ways of dealing with food waste and packaging?"

D3. Consumer Literacy and Numeracy

By the end of this course, students will:

D3.1 demonstrate the ability to make the calculations necessary for purchasing food (e.g., *keep a running total on a grocery list; calculate tips in restaurants; determine the value of using coupons; compare unit prices; calculate per-serving costs; calculate sales taxes*)

D3.2 use the information found on Canadian food labels (e.g., *ingredient lists, Nutrition Facts tables, “best-before” dates, lists of food additives*) to check for food safety and nutritional value

Teacher prompt: “What information provided on food labels is most relevant to you? What information might be most relevant to seniors?”

D3.3 describe and evaluate the effectiveness of common marketing and advertising techniques that are used to encourage consumers to buy (e.g., *coupons, product placement, end-of-aisle displays, brand recognition, celebrity endorsements, scare tactics*)

Teacher prompts: “What strategies do advertisers use to get our attention?” “What is a loss leader, and how effective are loss leaders at increasing overall sales in stores?” “How effective are end-of-aisle displays at increasing sales of products?”

D3.4 evaluate the reliability and credibility of nutrition claims from various sources (e.g., *infomercials, health claims and nutrition claims on food labels, websites, blogs, public-service announcements*)

Teacher prompts: “What forms of media provide information about food and health? How can you determine what is reliable and

credible information from these sources?” “How does media information compare with information provided by Health Canada? What biases might Health Canada show in their nutrition information? What are some of the underlying assumptions of Health Canada’s recommendations?”

D4. Eating Out

By the end of this course, students will:

D4.1 identify various factors to consider when choosing a place to eat (e.g., *food preferences of dinner companions, cost, type of restaurant, time available*)

D4.2 describe the type of information commonly provided on menus (e.g., *categories of dishes, ingredients, prices, cooking method used*)

D4.3 describe the behaviour of a courteous customer in a variety of eating venues of different levels of formality (e.g., *making reservations; appropriately getting a server’s attention; observing etiquette appropriate to the type of establishment and situation; expressing dissatisfaction appropriately; dressing appropriately; disposing of waste after eating*)

Teacher prompt: “How would you interact with restaurant staff to ensure you receive good service?”

D4.4 demonstrate an understanding of tipping customs and practices (e.g., *determine whether tipping is appropriate or required; assess the quality of service; decide what percentage of the bill to leave as a tip; understand that tip money is shared with cooking staff and cleaning staff in some restaurants*)

E. FOOD AND THE WORKPLACE

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- E1. Preparing to Work in the Food Industry:** identify food-related occupations for which they are personally suited;
- E2. Successful Employment in the Food Industry:** demonstrate an understanding of the qualifications and skills required for successful employment in the food industry.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

E1. Preparing to Work in the Food Industry

By the end of this course, students will:

- E1.1** identify occupational opportunities in the food industry (*e.g., server, cook, chef, sous-chef, restaurant manager, food stylist, dietitian*)
Teacher prompt: "What resources can you consult to find out about food-related jobs/careers?"
- E1.2** identify personal knowledge, skills, and attitudes that may make them suited to occupations in the food industry
Teacher prompts: "How do your skills compare to the skills suggested for various food-related jobs/careers? What are your strengths? Where do you need further training or skills development?" "How could skills such as creativity or attention to detail be valuable for careers in the food industry?"
- E1.3** describe the training and knowledge required for a variety of occupations in the food industry (*e.g., knowledge of WHMIS regulations, Smart Serve training, Food Handler training, knowledge of common allergenic ingredients, CPR training, First Aid training, knowledge of workers' rights and responsibilities*)
- E1.4** describe short-term and long-term strategies they could use to secure and maintain employment in the food industry

Teacher prompt: "How can a short-term training plan be used to obtain a food-related job/career?"

E2. Successful Employment in the Food Industry

By the end of this course, students will:

- E2.1** describe different types of relationships found in the workplace (*e.g., with co-workers, with managers, with clients*)
Teacher prompt: "What type of attitude would be helpful for working well with a variety of personalities in the workplace?"
- E2.2** identify various skills that are needed to manage interactions within the workplace (*e.g., communication skills; conflict-management skills; recognition of appropriate boundaries with colleagues, supervisors, and customers*)
Teacher prompt: "How would you interact/communicate to avoid or resolve conflicts with co-workers? Supervisors?"
- E2.3** describe appropriate workplace behaviour and appearance (*e.g., punctuality, efficient time management, appropriate dress, attention to personal grooming*)
- E2.4** explain why initiative, persistence, and motivation are important for career advancement in the food industry